

have no certainty and never can have certainty as to what is the true Text of Scripture. So why bother trying to talk about an inerrant Text in such a situation? And does not any claim about inspiration become relative?

Fee's treatment of 1 Corinthians 8:2-3 is only an extreme example of a mentality that pervades our churches. The margins of NIV and NASB are full of notes that undermine confidence in the integrity of the Text: "*some early MSS omit...*", "*many ancient authorities read...*", "*the earliest and best [worst, really] witnesses...*"; not to mention the brackets in the text proper that say to the reader that the enclosed material "certainly is not genuine". Why do they do this? Because they are following an eclectic text, and the editors of that text constructed it on the basis of subjective criteria, in turn based on false presuppositions. But no one of those editors believed the Bible to be God's infallible Word—indeed, they foisted plain errors of fact and contradictions upon their text. Would they not qualify as "sons of the disobedience" (Ephesians 2:2)? If so, it would mean that they were wide open to satanic interference in their minds. If anyone thinks that Satan would pass up such an opportunity to corrupt the Sacred Text he really does not believe what the Bible says about our enemy!

The phrase 'generational sin' implies that a whole generation is practicing that sin. It involves a very serious consequence: all subsequent generations receive that sin as part of their 'gene pool'; it is not perceived as 'sin', but as 'truth'. But being in fact a lie, it becomes a stronghold of Satan in their minds and is not questioned. The only deliverance from that sin comes when someone goes back to its beginning and analyzes and exposes the false presuppositions and reasoning that gave rise to the sin. But such a person should not expect to be well received. He will certainly be persecuted by the 'Establishment'. However, if he has a means of disseminating his findings, he can influence the future.

Now consider the consequences of this generational sin. It is difficult to really teach a Sunday School lesson anymore—there may be six different versions in the room and we start discussing the various texts and renderings; there is no authority for making a choice; no one knows for sure what God's word is! The footnotes, plus the versional differences (often significant), have undermined people's confidence in the integrity of the Text. If the preacher emends the Text from the pulpit, it is confusion compounded. The authority of the Scriptures has been undermined. Few have the confidence to stand up and say, "Thus says the LORD!" The practical result is that whenever some teaching of Scripture becomes inconvenient, for personal or cultural reasons, we simply talk around it, explain it away or just shrug it off. Unquestioned obedience to the normal meaning of the Text is now hopelessly out of fashion! After all, nowadays it is our reason